Informal letters include the sender's address at the top, but they do not need the recipient's address.

The date needs to be included at the top.

Informal letters can be addressed to the recipient's first name.

Informal letters can have a chattier tone and include some small talk.

This phrase is friendlier than *Yours truly* or *Sincerely*.

Santa Claus
Toy Workshop
Secret Mountain
North Pole

January 5, 2014

Dear Rudolf,

I hope you are sticking to your New Year's resolutions! How is the diet going?

Mrs. Claus and I wanted to thank you for hosting a fantastic New Year's Eve party. It was great fun for us all to celebrate together after a busy few weeks.

I hope that we can see you for dinner soon.

Best wishes,
Santa

Informal letters

Informal letters are used for someone the sender knows, such as a friend, a family member, or a person of the same age or younger. They might describe a place or experience, pass on news, or thank the recipient for something. Informal letters have a chattier tone, but still follow a set layout.

- A **job application** letter gives an employer the **first impression** of a candidate, so it needs to be perfect.
- A complaint letter should be **firm but polite**. A **rude** letter will only **annoy** the recipient and reduce the chance of an apology or compensation.

E-mails

E-mails to friends or family don't have to follow any particular rules. However, e-mails to people the sender doesn't know should use appropriate language and have a clear structure. More and more correspondence is now sent via e-mail, so writing an e-mail isn't an excuse to be sloppy.

E-mails need to have an appropriate and descriptive subject heading.

An e-mail should have a focused structure and use clear paragraphs.

Professional e-mails should end with a complimentary close, just like letters.

